Stroke Syndromes & Cerebrovascular Anatomy

Page 1: Anterior vs Posterior Circulation Stroke Syndromes

MCA, ACA, and PCA Vascular Territory Manifestations

High-Yield Clinical Concepts & Board Review Points:

- **Middle Cerebral Artery (MCA): Contralateral hemiparesis and hemisensory loss affecting face and arm > leg, plus a**
- **Anterior Cerebral Artery (ACA): Contralateral hemiparesis and hemisensory loss affecting the lower extremity > up**
- **Posterior Cerebral Artery (PCA): Contralateral homonymous hemianopia with macular sparing, alexia without agra**

CLINICAL PEARL & EXAM TRAP:

Pure motor stroke or pure sensory stroke suggests a lacunar infarct involving the posterior limb of the internal capsule o

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Page 2: Acute Ischemic Stroke Thrombolysis & Thrombectomy

Alteplase / Tenecteplase Time Windows and Mechanical Intervention

High-Yield Clinical Concepts & Board Review Points:

- **IV thrombolysis (tPA / Tenecteplase) is approved within 4.5 hours of symptom onset in eligible patients without he**
- **Blood pressure must be lowered to <185/110 mmHg prior to thrombolysis and maintained <180/105 mmHg for 24 h**
- **Endovascular mechanical thrombectomy is indicated within 24 hours for large vessel occlusions (internal carotid a**

CLINICAL PEARL & EXAM TRAP:

Absolute contraindications to IV thrombolysis include active internal bleeding, recent intracranial surgery or head trauma